

# Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

## High Streamflow Advisory - South Coast (Downgrade)

Issued: 10:45 AM March 21, 2026

The River Forecast Centre is **downgrading** to a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- North Shore Mountains and Metro Vancouver tributaries
- Howe Sound and the Sea-to-Sky Corridor including Squamish and Pemberton
- Sunshine Coast
- Lower Fraser tributaries and the Fraser Valley

### Weather Synopsis:

A multi-day atmospheric river impacted coastal British Columbia this week, bringing significant rainfall and snowmelt. Between Monday and Friday, precipitation totals ranged from 40 to 300 mm, with the heaviest amounts recorded around Howe Sound, the North Shore Mountains, the Coast Mountains, and into the Fraser Valley. Although mid- and high-elevation areas initially accumulated snow early in the event, rising freezing levels soon in the storm led to warming temperatures and net snow water equivalent losses of 20 to 100 mm at automated snow weather stations from Monday through today, contributing additional runoff. Precipitation eased yesterday, and cooler temperatures have since reduced snowmelt across the region.

### River Conditions:

Rivers across the region continue to recede following the peaks observed in the past few days. Many systems reached modest levels, generally in the 1-2 year return period range; however, some rivers in areas that received the heaviest precipitation and snowmelt reached 5-10 year return periods or higher and are now steadily declining. Flows in larger and lake-fed river systems remain elevated but are expected to continue easing through the weekend and into next week.

Peak flows recorded in the past few days included:

- KANAKA CREEK NEAR WEBSTER CORNERS (08MH076) – 110 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 5-10 year return period
- CHILLIWACK RIVER AT VEDDER CROSSING (08MH001) – 600 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 5 year return period
- COQUIHALLA RIVER BELOW NEEDLE CREEK (08MF062) – 44 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 5-10 year return period

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- COQUIHALLA RIVER ABOVE ALEXANDER CREEK (08MF068) – 370 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 2-5 year return period
- SUMAS RIVER NEAR HUNTINGDON (08MH029) – 30 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 2-5 year return period
- CEDAR CREEK ABOVE THE MOUTH (08MH166) – 63 m<sup>3</sup>/s – 2-5 year return period

Stay safe in and around rivers through the region. Be prepared for challenging driving conditions and potential road washouts and check local conditions on DriveBC.ca. Never drive through flood waters or across road washouts.

The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit [PreparedBC](#).

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.